

Part 1: My Life Story (Under 400 Words)

My name is Abdelrahman Eissa, and I am a Software Engineering student at Lassonde. I grew up in Cairo, Egypt, which is a beautiful place to live with nice people, great weather, and excellent educational opportunities if you actively seek them out. Navigating an environment where you must pursue high-quality paths taught me resourcefulness and shaped my self-driven approach to learning.

From a young age, technology deeply fascinated me. I used to take apart toys to modify them, and though early failures occurred due to a lack of core knowledge, they sparked a powerful curiosity regarding internal mechanics. My first real breakthrough came through Minecraft command blocks, where I discovered the thrill of programming by building a door that summoned lightning. When my dad challenged me to step away from gaming and learn something practical, I turned that restriction into an opportunity by diving into PC building and teaching myself C++ at age 15. Compiling my first "Hello World" program after hours of debugging simple missing semicolons remains one of the happiest, most patient milestones of my life.

Moving to Canada to study at a prestigious institution like York University was a dream come true. A core strength that drives my success here is my insistence on mastering fundamentals rather than memorizing edge cases, allowing me to understand core concepts deeply and rediscover mathematical or programming theorems on the fly. This mindset is heavily inspired by online educators Grant Sanderson (3Blue1Brown) and Javidx9 (OneLoneCoder). I admire their dedication to spreading knowledge without purely monetary incentives, which shaped my leadership belief that information should be shared openly.

This collaborative spirit is perfectly captured by my chosen artifact: a photograph of our first-place win at the 2024 YEC Junior Design Competition. This milestone represents how powerful competing perspectives can be when integrated effectively. Furthermore, explaining why a sub-optimal idea won't work frequently sparked modified, working solutions. It reflects my passion for collaborative problem-solving and my belief that great leadership involves giving every idea the time and space to evolve.



Part 2: Key Events

Key Event	Emotional Impact (+5 to 0 to -5)	Key Learning or Insight
Taking apart toys as a child	+1	Early failures happen due to a lack of core knowledge, but they spark a powerful curiosity about internal mechanics.
Discovering Minecraft command blocks	+3	This was the foundational spark that began my entire programming mindset and career path.
Dad's challenge	-1	Though initially disappointing, it taught me how to channel restrictions into constructive, practical learning.
Learning C++ & compiling Hello World	+5	One of the happiest moments of my life. It proved the immense reward of patience and meticulous debugging.
Moving to Canada / Entering York U	+5	Realizing a major dream to study at a prestigious institution. It reinforced the value of setting high goals.
Winning the YEC Junior Design Competition	+5	An unexpected, joyful win that proved how listening to competing viewpoints yields superior engineering designs.

Part 3: Key Events as a chart

